

Monday, 24 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Partly cloudy 22° 15°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 22° 12°	MANCHESTER Partly cloudy 21° 14°	GLASGOW Overcast 22° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Wicker Man director's sons complete their late father's film trilogy.
The final film in the folk horror trilogy brings closure to the saga as well as its creator's family after more than 50 years.
UK · NEWS
- 2

Iran-linked hackers behind cyber attack that shut down power plant, reports say.
The government says at no point was there a risk to the UK's energy system during the attack in July.
UK · NEWS
- 3

'My skin makes me unique and I'm learning to embrace it'.
Laura Kelly, 28, was born with congenital melanocytic naevus (CMN) and underwent 14 operations as a baby.
UK · NEWS
- 4

Davis 'grateful' for support over cancer diagnosis.
The Office star was appearing at convention in London, less than two weeks after announcing her condition.
UK · NEWS
- 5

Baby whose parents feared had just days to live is 'thriving' after life-saving heart operation.
Doctors have told mum and dad Catrin and Dylan it could take years for a donor to materialise.
UK · NEWS

What's coming up

1

Prince Harry and six others face privacy case legal bill of up to £34.5m.

The seven claimants, who include Sir Elton John and Liz Hurley, have to pay the Daily Mail publisher an initial £9.54m in the next seven days after losing a privacy case.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

US rapper BigXthaPlug arrested on drug and gun charges.

The rapper, who has faced similar charges in the past, had been due to perform at the Country Rising Festival.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

Tupac murder accused told police in 2008 his nephew fired fatal shots.

A recording of the interview Duane Davis conducted with detectives was played to the jury.

SHOWBIZ · UK

4

British rapper Yung Filly to face retrial on rape charges in Australia.

A jury last month cleared the YouTuber of several sexual assault offences, but it couldn't reach a decision on three others.

SHOWBIZ · UK

5

Tributes paid to 'giant' of Irish traditional music scene.

Eithne Vallely, who was 81, was originally from Donegal, but had lived for decades in Armagh.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 ECB investigating Carse 'nightclub incident'.**
The ECB is investigating after videos circulating online appear to show England bowler Brydon Carse being led away from a nightclub in handcuffs.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Sub Cherki rescues result for Maresca - player ratings for Man City v Bournemouth.**
How Man City and Bournemouth players rated following their Premier League match.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Kane first Englishman to win Germany's player of the year award.**
Harry Kane has been voted 2026 German footballer of the year, becoming the first Englishman to win the award.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Abuse from Liverpool fans hurts - Alexander-Arnold.**
Trent Alexander-Arnold says he still receives abuse from Liverpool fans online after leaving Anfield for Real Madrid 14 months ago.
SPORT · UK
- 5 Hull shock Man Utd with dream Premier League return.**
Watch highlights as Hull City make a dream start to their return to the Premier League, beating Manchester United 2-0 on the opening weekend at the MKM Stadium.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Good news for those who love a bit of a natter while they walk!**
New research suggests that 'walking groups' don't just boost physical health, but significantly improve mental well-being and reduce feelings of loneliness. It seems a good chat makes the miles fly by!
- 2 The humble 'houseplant' is apparently making us all a little bit calmer.**
A recent study found that simply having green plants in our living spaces can lower stress levels and improve concentration. Time to invest in a new fern, perhaps?
- 3 Ever wondered what our pets get up to when we're out?**
New tracking technology reveals that many dogs spend a surprising amount of time 'looking out the window' at passers-by, almost like their own version of people-watching. Fascinating stuff!
- 4 British seaside towns are seeing a lovely resurgence in popularity.**
A new report highlights a renewed appreciation for traditional coastal holidays, with families flocking to enjoy fish and chips, sandcastles, and the timeless charm of the British coast.
- 5 Scientists are exploring the fascinating world of 'animal friendships'.**
It turns out that many species form unlikely bonds, such as dogs and deer, or even cats and birds, showing that companionship isn't just for humans.
- 6 A delightful trend of 'community art projects' is sweeping across the UK.**
From painted benches to knitted tree decorations, local communities are embracing creative ways to brighten public spaces and bring people together.
- 7 The simple act of 'doodling' during a meeting might actually be a good thing.**
Psychologists suggest that these seemingly idle scribbles can help us focus, retain information, and even spark new ideas. So, grab a pen!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new piece of clothing will be comfortable for a whole day?

ANSWER: ...GIVING IT A QUICK STRETCH OR TUG IN VARIOUS PLACES WHEN NO ONE'S LOOKING!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh slice of toast from a new loaf of bread. What is it?

ANSWER: ...TAPPING THE SIDE OF THE LOAF A FEW TIMES, JUST TO CHECK FOR FRESHNESS!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'song on the radio' just perfectly matches your mood, even if you hadn't heard it in ages?**
What's that one song that always seems to pop up at just the right moment for you, and what mood does it usually find you in?
- **We all have those 'little everyday inventions' that we absolutely couldn't do without, even if they seem minor to others, don't we?**
What's a small, unassuming item in your home or daily life that you genuinely couldn't imagine living without now? Perhaps it's a specific kitchen gadget or a handy tool.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that flamingos are not born pink? Their famous colour comes from the beta-carotene in their diet of brine shrimp and algae.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of pandas is officially called an 'embarrassment'? They are very shy creatures, you see.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The shortest complete English sentence is 'I am'.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The world's first recorded traffic light was installed in London in 1868, near the Houses of Parliament.
- The average cloud weighs around 1.1 million pounds.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is believed to be the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.

On this day

Day 236 of the year, 129 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aurea of Ostia; Christian feast day: Bartholomew the Apostle (Roman Catholic, Anglican); Christian feast day: Edward Klinik; Christian feast day: Emily de Vialar. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Stephen Fry, English actor, journalist, producer, and screenwriter
- 1945 — Ronee Blakley, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1995 — Lady Amelia Windsor, member of the British royal family
- 1940 — Madsen Pirie, British academic, President and co-founder of the Adam Smith Institute
- 1988 — Rupert Grint, English actor
- 1942 — Jimmy Soul, American pop-soul singer (died 1988)
- 1938 — David Freiberg, American singer and bass player
- 1961 — Jared Harris, English actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1989 — Colombian drug barons declare "total war" on the Colombian government.
- 2020 — Erin O'Toole is elected leader of the Conservative Party of Canada.
- 2023 — Japan officially begins discharging treated radioactive water from the Fukushima Daiichi Nuclear Power Plant into the Pacific Ocean, sparking international concerns and condemnation.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Microsoft releases Windows 95 to the public in North America.
- 2004 — Ninety passengers die after two airliners explode after flying out of Domodedovo International Airport, near Moscow. The explosions are caused by suicide bombers from Chechnya.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2010 — Agni Air Flight 101 crashes near Shikharpur, Makwanpur, Nepal, killing all 14 people on board.
- 1981 — Mark David Chapman is sentenced to 20 years to life in prison for murdering John Lennon.
- 1989 — Colombian drug barons declare "total war" on the Colombian government.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 237 of the year, 128 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æbbe of Coldingham; Christian feast day: Aredius; Christian feast day: Genesisius of Arles; Christian feast day: Genesisius of Rome. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1963 — Shock G, American rapper and producer (died 2021)
- 1949 — Gene Simmons, Israeli-American singer-songwriter, producer, and actor
- 1970 — Jo Dee Messina, American singer-songwriter
- 1978 — Kel Mitchell, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1977 — Jonathan Togo, American actor
- 1968 — Spider One, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1969 — Catriona Matthew, Scottish golfer
- 1961 — Ally Walker, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1967 — George Lincoln Rockwell, founder of the American Nazi Party, is assassinated by a former member of his group.
- 1991 — Linus Torvalds announces the first version of what will become Linux.
- 2001 — American singer Aaliyah and several members of her entourage are killed as their overloaded aircraft crashes shortly after takeoff from Marsh Harbour Airport, Bahamas.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2010 — A Filair Let L-410 Turbolet crashes on approach to Bandundu Airport, killing 20.
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Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar